

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Aviation English

Conversation lab

8 complete workplace dialogues, followed by eight additional role-play cases. Study the exchanges, then make the conversation your own.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Find the right language. Speak, write, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For aviation operations managers, airline staff, maintenance coordinators, safety teams, dispatchers, airport operations staff, ground handlers, and aviation-adjacent professionals.

Workplace coordination English. This course does not teach radiotelephony phraseology or certify aviation language proficiency; operational communication follows approved aviation procedures.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

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Inside this conversation lab

Original fictional training conversations in professional English. These are realistic scripts, not transcripts of actual people. The professional roles are the speaker labels; all figures, incidents, and organizations are invented.

01 A ramp safety concern

02 Operations control update

03 Maintenance status clarification

04 Passenger disruption update

05 Turnaround coordination

06 Restricted-area access

07 Incident report review

08 Audit readiness

Then try eight independent role-play cases, followed by feedback criteria and references.

Read it. Hear it. Make it yours.

1. Read the setting. Identify the roles, the immediate problem, and what each speaker needs.
2. Read the whole conversation aloud with a partner. In a group, give a third person the observer role. For three-speaker scripts, assign each professional a separate voice.
3. Notice how the speakers ask a specific question, qualify a claim, disagree, explain a technical point, or agree on a next step. Underline language you would actually use.
4. Cover the script. Recreate the exchange using the situation and professional roles. Keep the meaning, but change the wording.
5. Switch roles and introduce a complication: a missing record, a different priority, an unavailable colleague, or a changed assumption. End with a clear outcome or unresolved question.

Register and terminology

These colleagues use concise professional language. In an internal technical meeting, familiar abbreviations can be natural. With a new colleague or a client, expand unfamiliar terms and check understanding. Keep disagreement directed at the evidence or proposal, and match the degree of certainty to what is known.

Independent study

Speak each role aloud. Pause before the reply and supply your own response before revealing the next line. Record a second version using invented details, then compare its clarity and tone with the script.

Professional context

Workplace coordination English. This course does not teach radiotelephony phraseology or certify aviation language proficiency; operational communication follows approved aviation procedures.

FULL DIALOGUE 01 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

A ramp safety concern

Ground staff raise a concern before turnaround work continues.

Roles: Ramp agent / Ramp supervisor

Ramp agent: The equipment is positioned inside the marked clearance area. I've stopped my task and raised the concern.

Ramp supervisor: Thank you. Keep the activity paused while we assess it through the approved ramp procedure.

Ramp agent: The departure is already late. Operations is asking us to recover time.

Ramp supervisor: I'll coordinate the delay impact. Schedule pressure doesn't remove the safety concern.

Ramp agent: I'll give you the equipment reference and the observed position.

Ramp supervisor: I'll arrange the authorized correction and confirm the conditions for resuming work.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "The equipment is positioned inside the marked clearance area. I've stopped my task and raised the concern." What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 02 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Operations control update

Airline staff coordinate a delayed inbound aircraft.

Roles: Operations controller / Station manager

Operations controller: The inbound is delayed, and the current arrival estimate remains subject to change.

Station manager: Which onward services and ground resources should we review first?

Operations controller: The connecting passengers, crew availability, and turnaround resources. The responsible teams are checking the constraints.

Station manager: I'll confirm gate and handling availability rather than assume the original plan still works.

Operations controller: I'll keep the operating options separate from any decision still awaiting authorized approval.

Station manager: Send the next confirmed update so our passenger communication matches the actual operational status.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "Which onward services and ground resources should we review first?" What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 03 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Maintenance status clarification

Operations asks about an aircraft maintenance item.

Roles: Operations coordinator / Maintenance controller

Operations coordinator: The report mentions a possible deferral. Does that mean the aircraft is cleared to operate?

Maintenance controller: No. Applicability, conditions, and required actions must be assessed under the approved maintenance process.

Operations coordinator: I should keep the aircraft status pending rather than say the item is resolved.

Maintenance controller: Correct. The authorized maintenance personnel will communicate the recorded disposition.

Operations coordinator: I'll update operations with that distinction and avoid interpreting the MEL entry myself.

Maintenance controller: I'll provide the confirmed status and any operational coordination requirements through the established channel.

Notice the professional language

MEL - Minimum equipment list identifying aircraft equipment that may be inoperative under specified conditions while the aircraft remains dispatchable.

Rehearse and extend

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 04 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Passenger disruption update

An airport team prepares a delay announcement.

Roles: Gate supervisor / Customer service manager

Gate supervisor: Passengers are asking whether the flight will depart in thirty minutes. We don't have that confirmation.

Customer service manager: State the verified delay and give a time for the next update, not an invented departure time.

Gate supervisor: Some passengers may miss connections. Can we begin reviewing assistance options?

Customer service manager: Yes, through the applicable rebooking and assistance process, using their actual itineraries.

Gate supervisor: I'll coordinate the queue and keep individual details out of the public announcement.

Customer service manager: I'll arrange additional service support and brief the team on the current information.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "Some passengers may miss connections. Can we begin reviewing assistance options?"
What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 05 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Turnaround coordination

A station team reviews a late turnaround task.

Roles: Turnaround coordinator / Ground handling lead

Turnaround coordinator: The cleaning task is complete, but the loading update hasn't been acknowledged.

Ground handling lead: I'll confirm the status with the authorized loading team. We shouldn't infer completion from an empty belt.

Turnaround coordinator: Please identify any outstanding task and its owner.

Ground handling lead: I will. The relevant records and checks must be completed through the approved process.

Turnaround coordinator: I'll update the turnaround plan using confirmed milestones.

Ground handling lead: I'll report back through the agreed channel so all teams work from the same status.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "The cleaning task is complete, but the loading update hasn't been acknowledged." What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 06 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Restricted-area access

An airport contractor arrives without confirmed access authorization.

Roles: Airport operations officer / Contractor coordinator

Airport operations officer: The technician is here, but their access authorization isn't confirmed in our system.

Contractor coordinator: I'll contact the authorized access team. They shouldn't enter while that remains unresolved.

Airport operations officer: Can you verify the work order and the required escort arrangements too?

Contractor coordinator: Yes, through the airport's approved access process.

Airport operations officer: I'll explain the delay to the maintenance coordinator without bypassing the check.

Contractor coordinator: I'll confirm the permitted arrangements once the access team has reviewed the request.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "Can you verify the work order and the required escort arrangements too?" What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 07 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Incident report review

A safety team checks a factual occurrence report.

Roles: Safety analyst / Ground operations supervisor

Safety analyst: The draft says the driver was distracted. Is that observed or inferred?

Ground operations supervisor: Inferred. We observed the vehicle cross the line; we don't know why.

Safety analyst: Record the movement, time, location, and available evidence without assigning an unconfirmed cause.

Ground operations supervisor: I'll preserve the reports and route them through the occurrence-reporting process.

Safety analyst: Keep witness accounts distinguishable from the investigation's later findings.

Ground operations supervisor: I'll revise the wording and make sure the responsible safety team receives the complete factual record.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "The draft says the driver was distracted. Is that observed or inferred?" What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 08 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Audit readiness

An aviation team reviews missing training evidence.

Roles: Compliance coordinator / Operations manager

Compliance coordinator: The readiness checklist shows two training records we haven't verified.

Operations manager: The staff may have completed the sessions. Can we mark them complete provisionally?

Compliance coordinator: Mark the evidence status accurately and verify it through the approved records.

Operations manager: I'll contact the training team and identify any actual completion gaps.

Compliance coordinator: Record corrective actions with real dates; don't reconstruct attendance as if it were contemporaneous.

Operations manager: I'll track the actions and present the unresolved items openly at the readiness review.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "The staff may have completed the sessions. Can we mark them complete provisionally?"
What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

Eight more situations to make your own

The following cases are open role plays. They give you facts, contrasting roles, useful expressions, and a short model response. Use what you learned from the complete dialogues to create a longer exchange.

Preparation: two minutes. Conversation: three to five minutes. Feedback: one minute. Switch roles and repeat with the second-round challenge.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 01

Safety Culture and Stop-Work Authority

SHARED CASE

In a ground-operations language exercise, a team member sees a possible hazard near equipment. The local safety process applies.

Role A | Responding professional

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You can help but need a clear request and its purpose. Ask what is required and whether the timing is fixed or negotiable.

Useful expressions

Could you provide ... so that ...?

Please confirm ... by [agreed time].

If that timing is not possible, please let me know

Cover this until after your first attempt

I see a possible hazard near the equipment. Please alert the responsible person and follow the local safety process. I'll state the location and observation clearly so the concern can be assessed.

Second round

The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Debrief

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 02

Operations Control and Dispatch Coordination

SHARED CASE

An operations update has a provisional aircraft assignment and an unresolved crew-status question. A draft message calls the plan confirmed.

Role A | Responding professional

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to brief someone who has only one minute. Ask what is complete, what is open, and which open item affects the next action.

Useful expressions

We have completed ...; ... remains open.

As of ..., the status is

The next update will cover

Cover this until after your first attempt

The aircraft assignment is provisional, and crew status still needs confirmation. I'll distinguish those open items from confirmed information in the operations update.

Second round

The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Debrief

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 03

Maintenance Deferrals and MEL Language

SHARED CASE

A maintenance coordination note mentions a deferral but omits the relevant reference and authorized status.

Role A | Responding professional

Clarify missing information before responding. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Useful expressions

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is Is that right?

Cover this until after your first attempt

Could you confirm the reference and current authorized status with maintenance control? I need accurate coordination information; I cannot infer airworthiness from an incomplete note.

Second round

The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Debrief

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 04

Irregular Operations and Passenger Communication

SHARED CASE

Passengers receive conflicting messages about a delay. The next departure estimate has not been confirmed.

Role A | Responding professional

Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You are frustrated because an earlier message created an expectation. Explain that expectation. Ask your partner to distinguish the correction from anything still uncertain.

Useful expressions

My earlier message did not make ... clear.

I'm sorry for The correct information is

Let me check that the revised explanation addresses

Cover this until after your first attempt

I'm sorry for the conflicting information. We are waiting for a confirmed update from the responsible team. I'll share the next verified information and explain the available assistance through our process.

Second round

The listener remains disappointed after the correction. Acknowledge the impact and restate the available next step calmly.

Debrief

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 05

Ground Handling and Turnaround Performance

SHARED CASE

A turnaround handoff identifies an open ground-service task but does not name who accepted it.

Role A | Responding professional

Give a handoff that the receiving person can confirm. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You are taking over the work. Ask what remains open and repeat back the critical status or responsibility. Point out one detail that would be unsafe or misleading to assume.

Useful expressions

The current status is ...; the outstanding item is

The record shows

Please confirm who has accepted

Cover this until after your first attempt

This ground-service task is still open. Please confirm which team has accepted it and record the status in the agreed coordination channel before we describe the handoff as complete.

Second round

The intended recipient cannot take ownership. Keep the status clear and identify the need for an authorized reassignment.

Debrief

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 06

Security and Access Control

SHARED CASE

A visitor asks a staff member to bypass an access check because a meeting is running late.

Role A | Responding professional

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You can help but need a clear request and its purpose. Ask what is required and whether the timing is fixed or negotiable.

Useful expressions

Could you provide ... so that ...?

Please confirm ... by [agreed time].

If that timing is not possible, please let me know ...

Cover this until after your first attempt

I understand the meeting is urgent, but access still needs to follow the approved process. Let me contact the authorized team to arrange the appropriate check and escort if required.

Second round

The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Debrief

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 07

Incident Reporting and Investigation

SHARED CASE

An initial incident note says equipment damage was caused by a specific action, although the review is incomplete.

Role A | Responding professional

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Useful expressions

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Cover this until after your first attempt

The damage has been observed; its cause is still under review. I'll record the known sequence and distinguish witness reports from confirmed findings in the note.

Second round

Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Debrief

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 08

Regulatory Audits and Readiness

SHARED CASE

An audit preparation list has current records for most staff but three records still need verification.

Role A | Responding professional

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to brief someone who has only one minute. Ask what is complete, what is open, and which open item affects the next action.

Useful expressions

We have completed ...; ... remains open.

As of ..., the status is

The next update will cover

Cover this until after your first attempt

Most records have been checked; three remain unverified. I'll list those items, their owners, and the follow-up status so the audit update shows the outstanding work clearly.

Second round

The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Debrief

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

Workplace coordination English. This course does not teach radiotelephony phraseology or certify aviation language proficiency; operational communication follows approved aviation procedures.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

FAA: aviation English standard

https://www.faa.gov/regulations_policies/advisory_circulars/index.cfm/go/document.information/documentID/1031388

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.